
AN ILLUSTRATED NOVEL
Malin
The Eyes of Vala
Sometimes,
to move the world
forward...
you have to be brave
enough to run
backward first.
Bruno
BHIM MONDAL

Chapter 1
A Strange Habit

In the quiet town of Nila Valley, fourteen-year-old Malin was known for only one strange habit — she liked doing things backward.

She wrote her name from the last letter first. She walked home by reversing her usual path. Even her laughter sometimes came out like a reverse echo.

No one understood why. Her classmates found it amusing. Her teachers found it distracting. Only her grandmother, who still followed the old ways, would sometimes look at her with quiet eyes and say nothing.



2. The Blue Stone

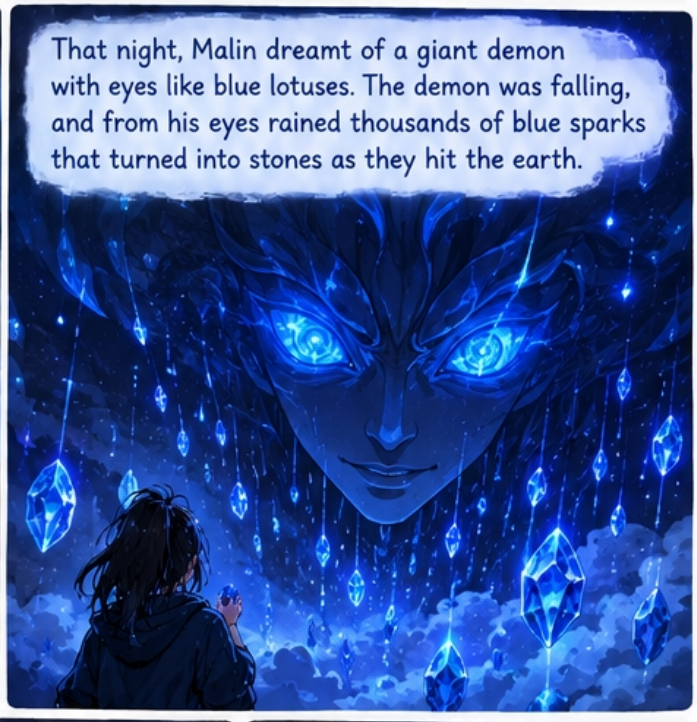
One monsoon evening, while chasing her dog Bruno through the abandoned park near the old temple, Malin tripped over something hard and glowing.





It was a deep-blue stoone, roughly the size of a small egg, half-buried in the wet earth. The moment her fingers touched it, a cold electric current shot up her arm.

The stone pulsed once... twice... and then went quiet.



That night, Malin dreamt of a giant demon with eyes like blue lotuses. The demon was falling, and from his eyes rained thousands of blue sparks that turned into stones as they hit the earth.



"These are the eyes of Vala. One of them has chosen you."



She woke up with the blue stone still clutched in her hand.



Outside her window, the rain was falling upward for just a moment — before the world remembered its proper direction.

3. The First Reverse

The next morning, Malin discovered her powers.

When she ran, time slowed. When she concentrated, small things moved backward — a falling glass rose back onto the table, a torn notebook page joined itself again, raindrops lifted from the ground and returned to the clouds for a few seconds.

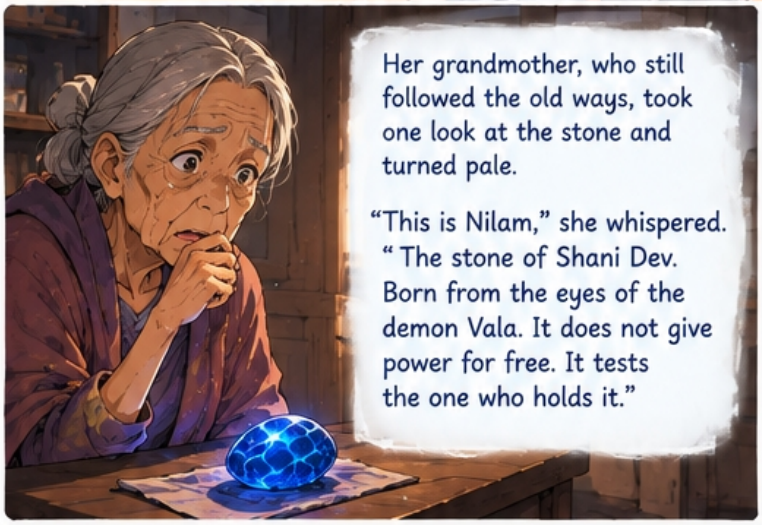
The stone had given her the power of reversal.











Her grandmother, who still followed the old ways, took one look at the stone and turned pale.

"This is Nilam," she whispered. " The stone of Shani Dev. Born from the eyes of the demon Vala. It does not give power for free. It tests the one who holds it."



Malin only smiled. For the first time in her life, she felt she was meant for something bigger.



That afternoon she tested her limits. She stood in the middle of the park and spun once. For three full seconds, the wind reversed direction.

Leaves that had fallen rose back to their branches.

A crow flying forward suddenly found itself flying the other way, looking thoroughly confused.

Malin laughed — a clear, bright sound that seemed to ripple both forward and backward through the air.

4. The Shadow of Shani

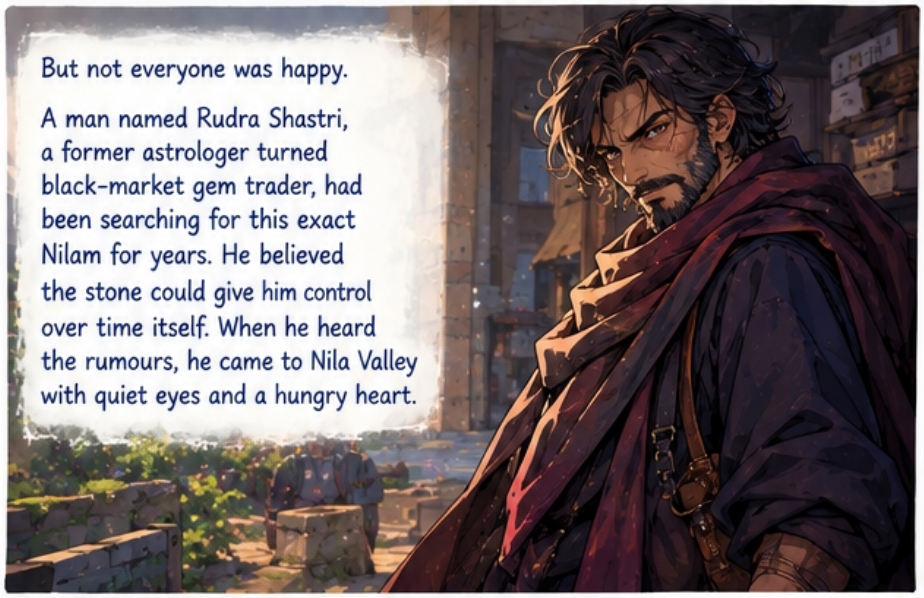
News of strange events began spreading through Nila Valley.

Pollution from the old chemical factory that had been killing the river suddenly started reversing. Dead fish floated back to life for a few moments. Yellow leaves turned green again. People whispered about a blue blur racing across the sky at night.

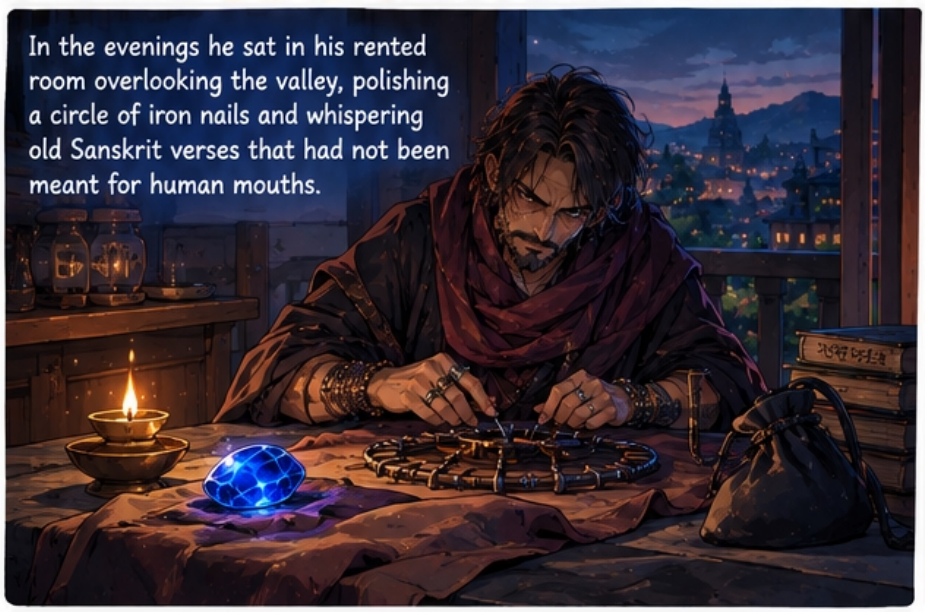


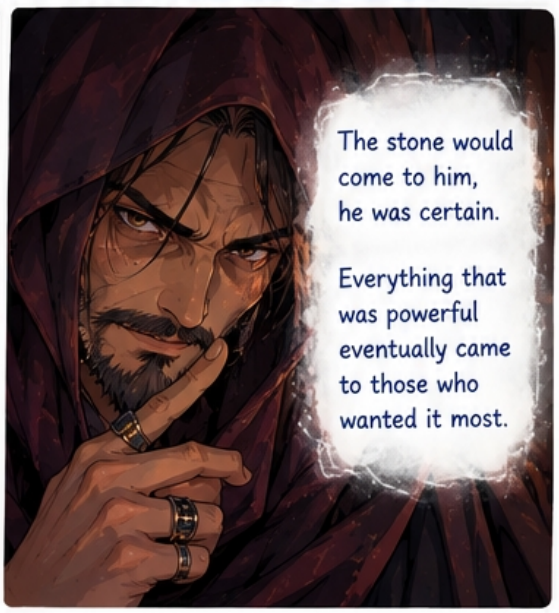












5. The Trial Begins

One night, Rudra's men kidnapped Malin's grandmother and left a message written in careful handwriting:

Bring the Nilam to the old temple at midnight.... or she dies..

Malin went.

The temple stood at the edge of the valley, its stones black with age and monsoon.

At the entrance, Rudra waited with a circle of iron nails and black candles — an old ritual meant to bind Shani's stone to a new master.

You are just a child, he said, almost gently. "The Nilam is wasted on you. **Give it to me**, and I will let your grandmother live. I will even let you keep a small piece of the power, if you wish."

Malin looked at the glowing blue stone in her palm. For the first time, it felt heavy — as if it carried the weight of every eye that had ever looked upon the world and judged it.

She remembered her grandmother's words:

"It tests the one who holds it."

Instead of giving the stone away, Malin closed her eyes and ran.

She ran backward.

6. The Night of Reversal



As Malin ran, the world around the temple began to reverse.

The black candles un-burned, their flames shrinking back into the wicks until only cold wax remained. The iron nails flew back into Rudra's bag with sharp metallic sounds. The ropes binding her grandmother loosened, twisted, and fell away like tired snakes.



Even the dark clouds above the valley started moving in reverse, thinning, revealing a clean white moon.

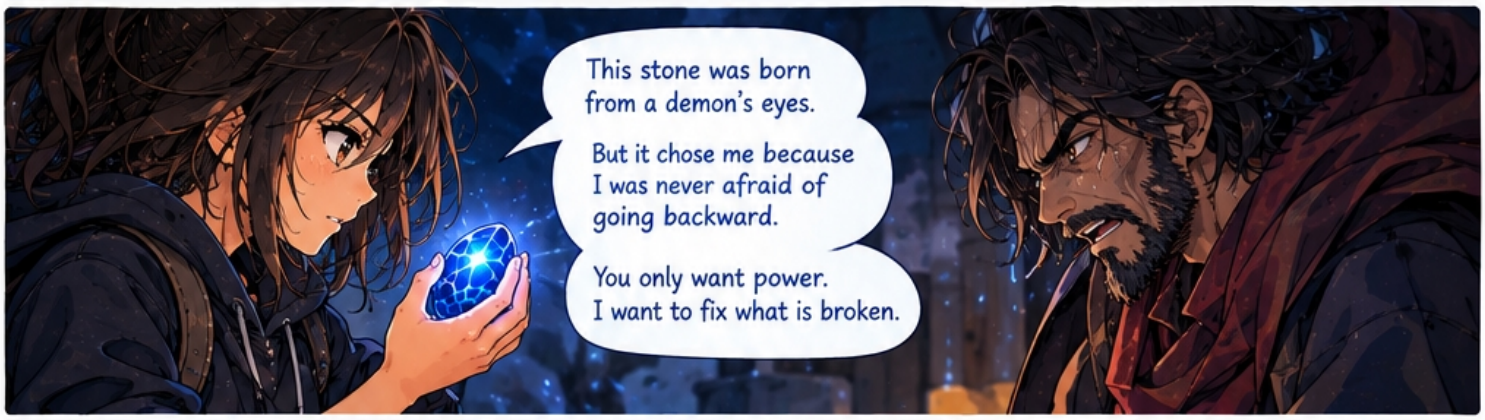


Rudra screamed and tried to snatch the stone, but every step he took forward was pulled backward by an invisible force.

His feet slid. His hands grasped only air.



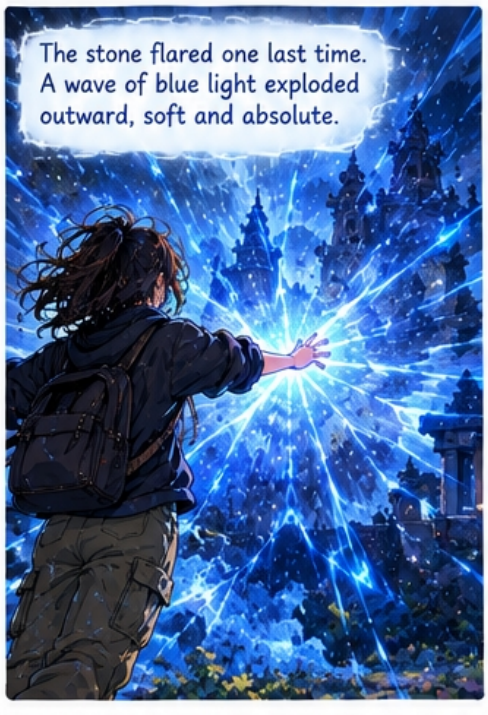
The more he struggled toward the power, the farther it retreated.



This stone was born from a demon's eyes.

But it chose me because I was never afraid of going backward.

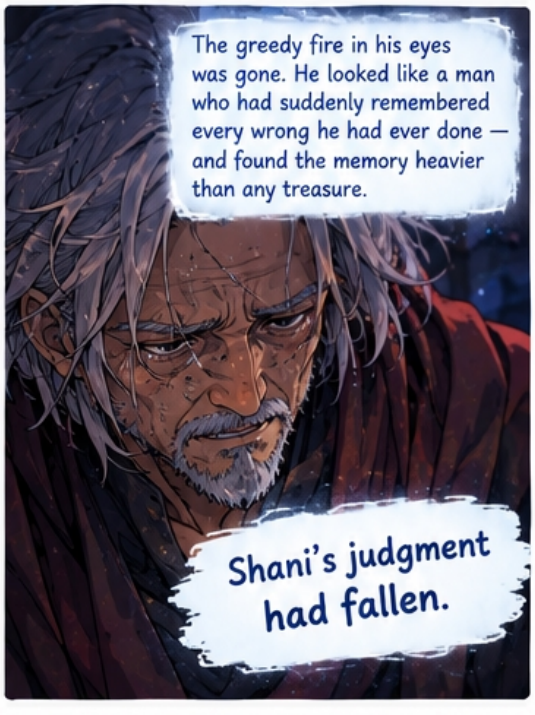
You only want power. I want to fix what is broken.



The stone flared one last time. A wave of blue light exploded outward, soft and absolute.



When the light faded, Rudra was on his knees, his hair turned completely white.



The greedy fire in his eyes was gone. He looked like a man who had suddenly remembered every wrong he had ever done — and found the memory heavier than any treasure.

Shani's judgment had fallen.

7. The Girl Who Runs Both Ways

In the days that followed, Nila Valley changed.

The river became clean. The factory was shut down and turned into a research centre for clean energy.



Children who had once been afraid of the dark now pointed at the night sky and whispered stories about the blue blur that raced across the clouds.



People started calling her Supergirl Malin.

But Malin never wore a fancy costume. She only wore the simple blue scarf her grandmother had stitched, and the Nilam stone set in a small silver pendant around her neck.



Sometimes, when children asked her why her name was Malin, she would smile and say:



"Because Nilam spelled backward is Malin.

And sometimes, to move the world forward... you have to be brave enough to run backward first."





And high above the valley, whenever the night sky turned deep blue, the stone on her neck would glow softly —

as if the eyes of the ancient demon Vala were still watching... and approving.